Minutes of Industrial Advisory Board Meeting

Faculty of Computing

Date: 7th May, 2025
Time: 1400 hrs.
Location: Board Room, Jinnah Auditorium, NUST, H-12 Islamabad

Attendees (Industry):

1. Zain ul Hassan Khan, VP Confiz Pvt. Ltd.
2. Owais Anjum, CEO, EMUMBA
3. Ali Tariq, CEO, Bytesquad
4. Waleed Riaz, Co Founder & COO, DPL IT
5. Asim Ghaffar, 10Pearls
6. Sohaib Tariq, Product Manager, APIMATIC
7. Ameen Sharif, ITNIS Consulting
8. Aadil Jaleel, CEO, VRESOLV.IO

Attendees (SEECS):

1. Dr. Momina Moetesum, HoD SE
2. Dr. M Imran Malik, HoD CS
3. Dr. Rafia Mumtaz
4. Dr. Seemab Latif, HoD AI/DS
5. Dr. Mehdi Hussain, HoD IS
6. Dr. Qaisar Riaz
7. Dr. Syed Imran Ali
8. Umer Nasim Ramay

Opening Remarks:

The meeting began with a brief presentation by Dr. Imran, who discussed updates and upcoming plans. These included new courses introduced since the last Industrial Advisory (IB) meeting and the organization of industrial seminars for faculty, as suggested by an industry representative in the previous session. Following this, the forum was opened for general discussion and suggestions.

Discussion Highlights:

1. **Course Improvement Suggestions:**
   Mr.Zain ul Hassan provided feedback on the courses being offered, specifically suggesting that the focus of some courses, like applied AI in education, should be

broadened to cover general applications across different sectors. He also recommended introducing separate courses for DevOps and machine learning, emphasizing a broader perspective in these courses.

SEECS responded by mentioning a collaboration with NUST Business School to offer a course on smart agriculture, which would also cover the applied side of AI. the suggestion to expand the course scope was acknowledged and promised for reviewing.

2. **Industry and Academia Alignment (Faculty Placement):**
   Mr.Asim Ghaffar raised a concern about the gap between faculty expertise and the skills required by the industry. He suggested creating an intermediary step—such as a boot camp—that would prepare faculty members for industry roles, reducing the gap in technical skills. This boot camp would focus on practical tools, including those needed for productizing AI, and could be offered to PhD and MS scholars to better align them with industry expectations.

   SEECS Faculty agreed with this suggestion, acknowledging the need for faculty members to upgrade their skills to stay relevant. Ongoing skill development programs for students were mentioned but agreed that similar programs for faculty were necessary.

3. **Real-World Projects and Faculty Development:**
   The conversation shifted towards faculty development programs and real-world applications of AI. One example was a project related to the telecom industry, where faculty members would be expected to handle tasks like AI productization, model testing, and evaluation, as opposed to purely academic work.

   An experiment was mentioned from the previous year involving Dr. Zainab, a PhD scholar, who was instrumental in bridging the gap between theory and applied knowledge. This model was seen as successful and could be expanded to train more faculty members.

4. **Industry Collaborations and Mentorship:**
   The discussion continued with a mention of a U.S.-based company, Novatec X, which offers an 8-week mentorship program for students and researchers. The program focuses on turning research ideas into scalable industry solutions. The company is looking for local mentors to help integrate this program at a more affordable rate, given that the current subscription costs are high for students and researchers in Pakistan.

   A collaboration with Novatec X was suggested and local mentors to launch similar programs on a local platform, but the challenge of funding such initiatives was also highlighted.

5. **Resources for Students:**
   There was also a discussion on the challenges faced by students in accessing premium tools and resources. One potential solution was utilizing free credits offered by cloud platforms like Amazon, which had previously provided up to $100,000 in credits per

student. However, these credits are now limited. How these resources could be maximized within the constraints.

6. **Closing Remarks:**
   The meeting concluded with a call for further collaboration between faculty and industry to ensure that graduates are well-prepared for the challenges of the tech industry. Dr. Imran also mentioned his interest in discussing some of these ideas offline to move forward with actionable plans.

Action Points	Recommendations
1. Review Course Structure	Broaden the focus of courses like Applied AI in Education to cover applications across various sectors.
	Introduce separate courses for DevOps and Machine Learning, ensuring a broader perspective in these subjects.
2. Organize Faculty Boot Camp	Create a boot camp to prepare faculty for industry roles, focusing on practical tools like productizing AI.
	Offer this boot camp to PhD and MS scholars to reduce the gap in technical skills between academia and industry.
3. Industry Collaborations & Mentorship	Collaborate with companies like Novatec X to bring affordable mentorship and internship opportunities to students.
	Engage local mentors to make mentorship programs more accessible and affordable for students and researchers.
4. Provide Access to Premium Tools for Students & Faculty	Investigate ways to provide access to premium tools, especially for cloud computing and AI, despite limitations.
	Maximize the use of free credits offered by cloud platforms like Amazon for students, ensuring efficient usage.

The meeting reflected a proactive approach to improving the quality of education at SEECS and aligning it more closely with industry needs.